

Lesson 1: Where We Are

Student Guide · High School

Name: _____

Date: _____

Period: _____

This lesson explains where the Nolan Xavier Wells case stands after the grand jury decision and which legal paths remain open.

01 Watch and fill in

Fill in the blanks while you watch the video.

1. On September 21, 2026, the grand jury returned a _____, meaning no one was charged.
2. Mississippi Today reported _____ subpoenas and _____ witnesses in the process.
3. The state autopsy listed the cause and manner of death as _____.
4. The family's attorney pointed out there was no fluid in the airway, lungs or _____.
5. The roadmap's next steps: a civil lawsuit, _____, and new evidence.
6. Mississippi Code 99-1-5 sets no _____ for murder.

02 Vocabulary

Define each term in your own words. Then use it in a sentence about the lesson.

Term	My definition	Use it in a sentence
Grand jury		
No true bill		
Indictment		
Subpoena		
Autopsy		
Manner of death		
Statute of limitations		
Civil lawsuit		

03 Who does what?

Fill in each office's role and how the person gets the job. Use the video and the map.

Position	Responsibility in this case	Elected or appointed? By whom?
Sheriff		

Position	Responsibility in this case	Elected or appointed? By whom?
Coroner		
State Medical Examiner		
District Attorney (DA)		
Grand Jury		

04 Think about it

The grand jury met in secret. Give one reason for grand jury secrecy and one reason against it.

Some of these officials are elected and one is appointed. How might that change who they answer to?

Pick one statement from the video. Is it a verified fact, an official's statement, or a claim by one side? How can you tell?

05 Exit ticket

In one sentence, explain why "no charges" does not mean "case closed."



Learn more on your own time

Scan to open the interactive map for Lesson 1. Tap the lit-up offices, hover the i terms, read the sources and take the quiz.

lawrencetotimeh.com/class/#lesson1